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ATTRACTION: Rampurva

ALTERNATIVE NAMES:

Not Mentioned

LOCATION:

Near River Harbora (known as Anoma in ancient times)

DISTRICT / REGION:

West Champaran

CATEGORY:

Historical Site

OVERVIEW:

Rampurva is a significant historical and archaeological site located in West Champaran, near the River Harbora (ancient Anoma). It is renowned for the discovery of two huge Ashoka pillars. The site holds immense religious and historical importance as the legendary place where Lord Buddha embraced the life of an ascetic to seek the truth about human suffering.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION:

The site is marked by two massive Ashoka pillars excavated from the area. One of these pillars features six edicts etched onto its surface, with that particular side preserved under a concrete canopy. This pillar also bears engravings of a peacock and a bird. Originally, the pillars featured exquisite capitals: a Lion Capital, which is now preserved at the Indian Museum in Kolkata, and a magnificent Bull Capital, which currently graces the Rashtrapati Bhawan in New Delhi.

HISTORICAL OR CULTURAL SIGNIFICANCE:

Emperor Ashoka constructed these pillars to monumentalize a crucial turning point in Lord Buddha's life—his transition from a royal prince to a wandering ascetic.

LEGENDS, STORIES, OR TRADITIONS:

According to legend, after leaving his family and kingdom behind, Lord Buddha reached the banks of the Anoma River (now Harbora). Here, he changed out of his royal garments, adopted a sadhu's attire, and cut his hair locks, officially beginning his spiritual journey to find the cause of suffering for all living beings.

KEY HIGHLIGHTS:

- Two excavated Ashoka pillars.
- Six edicts etched on one of the pillars.
- Engravings of a peacock and a bird.

VISITOR INFORMATION:

Best Time To Visit:

Not Mentioned

Opening Hours:

Not Mentioned

Entry Fee:

Not Mentioned

Duration Recommended:

Not Mentioned

Photography:

Not Mentioned

Accessibility Information:

Not Mentioned

FACILITIES:

Not Mentioned

TRANSPORTATION:

Nearest Airport:

Jay Prakash Narayan International Airport (Patna)

Distance From Airport:

Not Mentioned

Nearest Railway Station:

Narkatiaganj Jn. and Bettiah Railway Station

Distance From Railway Station:

Not Mentioned

Nearest Bus Stand:

Not Mentioned

Distance From Bus Stand:

Not Mentioned

Road Connectivity:

West Champaran is well connected by road. Bus and Taxi Services can be used to reach here.

Nearest Tourist Information Centre:

Not Mentioned

Nearest Police Station:

Not Mentioned

Nearest Medical Facility:

Not Mentioned

NEARBY ATTRACTIONS:

- Lauria Nandangarh (Distance Not Mentioned)

FESTIVALS AND EVENTS:

Not Mentioned

LOCAL CULTURE AND EXPERIENCES:

Not Mentioned

LOCAL FOOD AND CUISINE:

Not Mentioned

SHOPPING AND SOUVENIRS:

Not Mentioned

ACCOMMODATION:

Not Mentioned

HOTELS:

Not Mentioned

LOCAL GUIDES:

Not Mentioned

TRAVEL OPERATORS:

Not Mentioned

IMPORTANT FACTS:

- The Lion Capital from one pillar is conserved at the Museum in Kolkata.
- The Bull Capital graces the Rashtrapati Bhawan in New Delhi.
- The local river Harbora was known as Anoma during the Buddha's period.

RETRIEVAL SUMMARY:

Rampurva, located in West Champaran near the River Harbora (ancient Anoma), is a major Buddhist historical site featuring two excavated Ashoka pillars. It marks the legendary spot where Lord Buddha discarded his royal attire to become an ascetic. Key highlights include six Ashokan edicts, a preserved Lion Capital (now in Kolkata), and a Bull Capital (now in New Delhi). It is accessible via Patna Airport and Bettiah/Narkatiaganj railway stations.

QUESTION-ANSWER FACTS:

Q: What is this attraction known for?

A: Rampurva is known for two huge Ashoka pillars and as the site where Buddha adopted an ascetic life.

Q: Where is it located?

A: It is located in West Champaran, near the River Harbora.

Q: Where are the capitals of the pillars currently housed?

A: The Lion Capital is at the Museum in Kolkata, and the Bull Capital is at Rashtrapati Bhawan in New Delhi.

Q: How can visitors reach it?

A: The nearest airport is in Patna, and the nearest railway stations are Narkatiaganj Jn. and Bettiah. It is well connected by road.

Q: What facilities are available?

A: Not Mentioned.

KEYWORDS:

Rampurva, West Champaran, Ashoka Pillars, River Harbora, Anoma River, Lord Buddha, Ascetic, Lion Capital, Bull Capital, Edicts, Maurya Period, Buddhist Circuit.

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